

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr SATHISH KUMAR NATARAJAN

Address: 3 The Dene Cheam SM2 7EG

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer objects to the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I object to the proposal for change of use to mixed Class F1 (place of worship) and Class F2 (community hub) together with extensions, increased height and associated cycle/refuse facilities.

My objection is based on material planning considerations, particularly the impact on residential amenity and the local highway/parking network, given the site's residential context.

1) Highway safety, congestion, and parking stress (peak impacts)

The proposed mixed F1/F2 use is likely to generate high peak arrivals and departures (e.g., Friday prayers, weekends, evening community events, and festivals). This can create short, intense pressure on local roads and kerbside space, leading to unsafe manoeuvres, obstruction of driveways, illegal parking, and congestion at peak times.

Request: The application should be refused unless the applicant provides robust evidence including:

- a Transport Statement/Assessment addressing peak periods and event days,
- a parking stress survey of surrounding streets at relevant times,
- a Travel Plan and operational measures (marshalling/stewarding, anti-idling, drop-off strategy).

2) Noise and disturbance to neighbouring residents

The use introduces a credible risk of unacceptable disturbance from:

- amplified sound/voice (depending on internal arrangements),
- and crucially noise from congregants arriving/leaving, doors closing, engines, and dispersal-often outside typical working hours.

Planning Inspectors have previously concluded that worship uses can cause unacceptable noise/disturbance to neighbours, including noting that sound insulation does not address noise from people arriving/leaving.

Request: Refusal unless supported by:

- a Noise Impact Assessment,
- a clear plan for hours, capacity, stewarding, dispersal, and complaints handling,
- enforceable conditions limiting hours and the frequency/scale of events.

3) Overdevelopment / design and height increase

The scheme includes a part one/part two-storey extension and increased height.

The Council should be satisfied that the resulting bulk, height and massing do not harm the streetscape or create undue impacts on neighbouring outlook, daylight, and general amenity.

Request: Refusal unless drawings and assessments demonstrate no unacceptable impact on neighbouring properties and the character of the area.

4) Uncertainty of operation (mixed F1 + F2)

A mixed worship + community hub use can materially increase total footfall and extend activity across more days and later hours than a single use. Without firm, enforceable operational parameters (hours, capacity, event schedule), the proposal is not capable of being properly assessed.

Request: At minimum, conditions (or a legal agreement where justified) should control:

- maximum occupancy,
- hours of use,
- limits on non-worship events,
- event management and stewarding,
- travel plan measures and review.

5) Refuse/cycle management and local amenity

Refuse/cycle stores must be sized, located, and managed to avoid odour, noise, visual clutter, and fly-tipping risk.